

Checkpoint clue cards

Cut the cards apart. Each card names an arboretum area: walk there, identify the tagged tree with your dichotomous key, and record the one clue that decided it.

Checkpoint 1

token ○

Pinetum

south of the Learning Center, along Loop Drive

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

Checkpoint 2

token ○

Oak Canopy

southeast of the Research and Collaboration Building

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

Checkpoint 3

token ○

Beech Grove

west of Dixon Hall, across the bluestone Accessible Path

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

Checkpoint 4

token ○

Native Formal Garden

southeast of Dixon Hall; the black gum alley

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

Checkpoint 5

token ○

Trident maple

a Delaware Valley tree-of-record; staff mark its post

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

Checkpoint 6

token ○

Katsura

a Delaware Valley tree-of-record; staff mark its post

Identify the tagged tree here. Your ID:

Deciding clue (circle one): leaf • bark • branching • seed

The specific feature you saw: _____

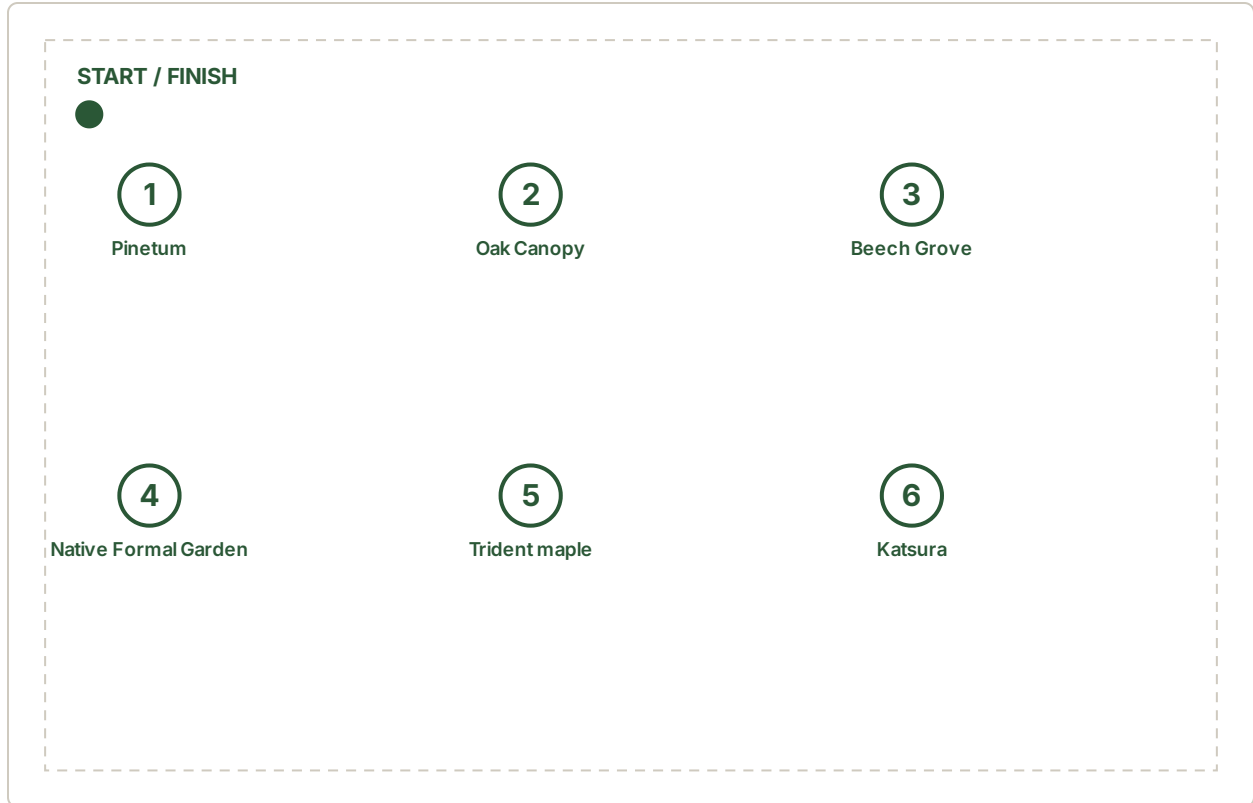
Tree dichotomous key

Keyed to the six trees on this route. Start at step 1 and follow the choice that matches what you see; keep going until you land on a tree name.

STEP	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	THEN
1a	Leaves are needles in soft bundles (evergreen)	Eastern white pine
1b	Leaves are broad and flat	go to 2
2a	Leaves grow in opposite pairs	go to 3
2b	Leaves grow alternately (staggered)	go to 4
3a	Leaf is one blade with three palm-like lobes	Trident maple
3b	Leaf is a single blade, heart-shaped, edge smooth	Katsura
4a	Leaf edge is lobed; acorns on or under the tree	Oak
4b	Leaf edge is smooth or finely toothed	go to 5
5a	Bark smooth gray, buds long and pointed	American beech
5b	Leaf glossy, bark dark and blocky, red fall color	Black gum

Route map

Six checkpoints through the Ambler Arboretum collection areas. Walk them in an order that avoids backtracking. The layout below is a schematic, not a to-scale path: a numbered post on the ground marks each checkpoint, and the list under the map tells you where each area is.



- 01 **1. Pinetum** — south of the Learning Center, along Loop Drive
- 02 **2. Oak Canopy** — southeast of the Research and Collaboration Building
- 03 **3. Beech Grove** — west of Dixon Hall, across the bluestone Accessible Path
- 04 **4. Native Formal Garden** — southeast of Dixon Hall; the black gum alley
- 05 **5. Trident maple** — a Delaware Valley tree-of-record; staff mark its post
- 06 **6. Katsura** — a Delaware Valley tree-of-record; staff mark its post

Evidence tokens (cut apart)

Cut the tokens apart. Your team collects one token for each checkpoint you solve; 6 tokens means you finished the whole quest.

 CP 1	 CP 2	 CP 3	 CP 4	 CP 5	 CP 6
 CP 1	 CP 2	 CP 3	 CP 4	 CP 5	 CP 6
 CP 1	 CP 2	 CP 3	 CP 4	 CP 5	 CP 6
 CP 1	 CP 2	 CP 3	 CP 4	 CP 5	 CP 6
 CP 1	 CP 2	 CP 3	 CP 4	 CP 5	 CP 6